The Venus Retrograde of Autumn 2026

A Reading for Austin, prepared by Urania on Saturday, September 26th, 2026

Opening frame

You are in the middle of a very particular kind of year. At age 39, your annual profection is the fourth whole sign house, which for you is Libra. The ruler of Libra is Venus. That makes Venus your Lord of the Year, the planet whose motion is amplified above all others for the twelve months that began on your birthday last May. Every transit of Venus lands more loudly than it would in another year. Every station of Venus is a station of the year itself. And this autumn Venus is about to do the loudest thing she can do. She is about to turn retrograde in Scorpio, where she is already in her detriment, and then she is going to walk backward across the sky for roughly forty days.

This is not a small transit. This is the central event of your solar year.

The mechanics of the retrograde

Venus enters her pre retrograde shadow in mid September at about 22 degrees Libra. She stations retrograde on Saturday, October 3rd, 2026, at 2:15 in the morning Chicago time, at 8 degrees and 29 minutes of Scorpio. She then moves backward through Scorpio, crossing back into Libra on approximately October 19th. She continues to reverse through Libra until Friday, November 13th, 2026, when she stations direct at 6:27 in the evening Chicago time, at 22 degrees and 52 minutes of Libra. She then moves forward again, retracing the arc she has already walked, and clears her post retrograde shadow around December 10th when she returns to the degree where she originally stationed retrograde at 8 degrees Scorpio.

So the full window you should hold in mind is approximately September 15th through December 10th. The three sharpest moments inside that window are the retrograde station on October 3rd, the sign change back into Libra around October 19th, and the direct station on November 13th.

Why this one is amplified for you specifically

Three separate factors are stacking on top of one another to make this retrograde loud in your chart.

The first factor is the one already named. Venus is your Lord of the Year. Any Venus motion this year is elevated. A Venus retrograde in your Venus year is the equivalent of the timekeeper of the year holding up her hand and asking you to look at something.

The second factor is the sign she is retrograding through. Venus rules Libra and Taurus. She is exalted in Pisces. She is in her detriment in Scorpio and in her fall in Virgo. She begins this retrograde in Scorpio, which means she begins in her weakest condition. As she retrogrades she moves backward out of Scorpio and into Libra, which is her own domicile, her strongest condition. So the arc of this retrograde is literally a journey from her worst position to her best position. That is unusual. That is meaningful. Traditionally read as a movement from stripped down or exposed material toward material that becomes properly ordered.

The third factor is where the retrograde lands in your chart. In your natal chart, using whole sign houses, Libra is your fourth house and Scorpio is your fifth house. The fourth house governs home, foundations, ancestry, family, private life, roots, and the internal life of the household. The fifth house governs children, creativity, pleasure, sex, play, and what you generate rather than what you inherit. Venus is going to spend forty days walking backward through the boundary between these two houses in your chart. She stations retrograde in the fifth house, she moves backward into the fourth house around October 19th, she stations direct deep in the fourth house on November 13th, and then she walks forward again into the fifth house through early December.

The reason this matters is that your annual profection year is the fourth house year. This is your Libra year, your fourth house year, your Venus year. And Venus is now going to retrograde through, back into, and then forward out of the very house that names the year. This is the year asking you to look carefully at the material of the fourth house. Ancestry. Foundations. Household. Family. Roots. Where you came from.

What Venus retrograde traditionally addresses

Ancient sources on Venus retrograde are consistent on a few themes. Rhetorius and Valens both treat Venus retrograde as a revision period for the matters Venus governs. Not a shutdown. Not a disaster. A revision. Modern Hellenistic practice, following Chris Brennan and Demetra George, tends to describe Venus retrograde in three registers.

The relational register. Old relationships resurface. Former partners, former friends, former loves make contact. Sometimes literally. Sometimes as memory or as dream. Current relationships get examined. What is the actual shape of this bond, versus what I have been

telling myself it is. Whether the answer is renewal or release depends on what the relationship actually is, not on what Venus is doing.

The valuation register. Venus governs what we value. During her retrograde, values themselves get reviewed. What am I actually paying for with my time. What am I claiming to want that I do not actually want. What am I refusing to name that I do want. Money and finances often show up here because money is a proxy for value, but the deeper question is about what the money is being spent on and why.

The aesthetic and creative register. What you have been making. What you have been wearing, decorating with, surrounding yourself with. What has become stale. What wants to be reworked. Artists frequently revise old work during Venus retrograde. Sometimes projects that were abandoned come back and ask to be finished.

For a fourth house profection year, all three of these registers land specifically on the fourth house material. So the questions become. What in the shape of your home wants to be revised. What in your ancestry is asking to be seen. What in your family relationships needs an honest look. What in the foundations you have been building is not actually stable and needs to be redone. What relationships from your past, especially relationships that touch home or family, may resurface. What you value about the private life you have made.

The specific transits Venus will make to your natal chart

Because Venus retrogrades and then covers the same degrees three times, most of the significant transits she makes to your natal points will perfect three times. Once on the way out. Once retrograde. Once on the way back. This is a hallmark of a retrograde cycle. The theme surfaces, gets revised, and then settles.

Here are the transits inside this retrograde arc that touch load bearing points in your chart, in chronological order.

On Sunday, September 27th, at 6:15 in the morning Chicago time, Venus makes a sextile to your natal Neptune. Neptune sits in your seventh house at 7 degrees Capricorn. Sextile is a mild supportive aspect, a 60 degree angle that traditionally reads as easy flow. Neptune in the seventh house is the imaginative and idealizing side of partnership. This is the first of three passes. Venus sextiles this Neptune again on October 8th while retrograde, and a third time on December 14th after she has gone direct. So a small triad on the partnership imagination side. Nothing loud, but it is the opening note.

On Saturday, October 3rd, at 2:15 in the morning Chicago time, Venus stations retrograde at 8 degrees Scorpio. Scorpio is your fifth house. The moment of the station is significant even if it does not perfect an aspect to a natal point. Traditionally read as the moment the retrograde theme becomes conscious. Pay attention to what shows up in the day or two on either side of October 3rd. That is often the signal event for the whole cycle.

On Saturday, October 31st, at 4:41 in the afternoon Chicago time, Venus retrograde makes a sextile to your natal Uranus. Uranus sits in your sixth house at 26 degrees Sagittarius, retrograde, conjunct your natal Saturn. Sextile is again the supportive angle. Venus touching this Saturn Uranus point in the sixth house of work and health is worth noting for its date alone. October 31st is Samhain. It is also inside the Deipnon window because the new moon is on November 8th, which means the last three nights before the new moon are the traditional Deipnon nights, October 31st through November 2nd. So Venus is making a supportive aspect to a chthonic natal configuration during the darkest lunar phase of the year, on a night that Hekate has been claimed by tradition for two thousand years. I am not telling you what to do with that. I am telling you what the sky is doing.

On Friday, November 13th, at 6:27 in the evening Chicago time, Venus stations direct at 22 degrees Libra. She is now in her own domicile, essentially dignified, moving forward. The direct station is the moment of resolution for the retrograde theme. Whatever surfaced around October 3rd finds its answer around November 13th. Not always in obvious ways. Sometimes the answer is a decision. Sometimes it is a release. Sometimes it is just clarity about what has been going on.

On Friday, November 27th, at 10:52 in the morning Chicago time, Venus direct makes her third sextile to your natal Uranus, closing the Saturn Uranus triad opened on October 31st.

On Monday, December 14th, at 6:16 in the evening Chicago time, Venus makes her third and final sextile to your natal Neptune. This closes the retrograde cycle proper.

Then, and this is the piece that most retrograde readings miss, Venus moves forward into a very rich sequence of transits to the load bearing points of your chart between late December and mid February. On December 23rd she trines your natal Moon. On December 28th she trines your natal Ascendant and sextiles your natal Descendant, both perfecting at the same moment because those angles are opposite one another. On January 1st, she sextiles your natal Lot of Fortune. On January 13th, she trines your natal Midheaven and sextiles your natal IC. On January 16th and 17th she trines both nodes of the moon. On January 19th she makes a Venus return, trine her own natal position. On January 20th she trines your natal Jupiter. This is a corridor of supportive Venus contacts to almost every load bearing point in

your chart, all in trines and sextiles, running roughly from Christmas week through late January. This is where the year that has been slowly gestating in the fourth house pays out. The retrograde is the work. This corridor is the result.

How to read the retrograde in your specific case

Given your chart and given your practice, three things are worth naming.

First, this is a chthonic retrograde. Scorpio is the traditional chthonic sign. Venus is uncomfortable there. She is uncomfortable in the same way that a beautiful thing is uncomfortable in a room full of shadows. She is not being destroyed. She is being asked to see what is in the shadow. For a practitioner devoted to Hekate, this is unusually resonant material. Venus walking backward through Scorpio, then crossing back into Libra to recompose herself, is a small mythic movement that echoes the Persephone descent and the Aphrodite Ourania distinction between the earthly and the heavenly Venus. Ancient sources are full of Venus in Scorpio being read as the Venus who has gone underground to see what she has been avoiding. She does not stay there. She comes back. But she comes back changed.

Second, because the retrograde arc runs from your fifth house back into your fourth house and then forward again, the material that is likely to surface will move in that direction. Whatever begins as an issue of pleasure, creativity, generativity, children, or sexual life may reveal itself, on the retrograde walk backward, to actually be a fourth house issue. Something about home. Something about roots. Something about the family you came from or the household you have made. And then when Venus stations direct in Libra deep in your fourth house on November 13th, the issue will resolve on the foundational side, not on the pleasure side. So if something surfaces during the first two weeks of October that seems to be about creative work or a pleasure or a fifth house matter, follow it backward with an open eye. It may be pointing at something deeper.

Third, your Lord of the Year is doing what Lords of the Year do. She is running the year. What emerges during this retrograde is likely to be the defining material of your entire age 39 profection year. Not a small event. A defining event. Whatever it is. Modal register, of course. Traditionally read as. Favors. Inclines toward. I do not predict specific events. But I do want to name clearly that a Venus retrograde in your Venus year, especially one that runs from her weakest to her strongest condition and passes through the profected house, is not background weather. It is the year showing its hand.

What to do with this information

A few practical suggestions, offered as suggestions rather than instructions.

Between now and October 3rd, notice what is on your mind about home, family, roots, ancestry, partnership, and value. Write down what surfaces. This is the pre shadow. What you notice now is the material the retrograde will work with.

On October 3rd, mark the day. Do not launch anything new that touches Venus material. Do not sign contracts of partnership. Do not commit to expensive purchases or renovations. Do not make declarations of love or its end. This is the traditional wisdom on Venus stations and it holds.

Between October 3rd and November 13th, expect Venus material to arrive. Old contacts. Old feelings. Old questions about the shape of your life. Meet what arrives. Do not run from it. Do not fix it prematurely. The whole point of a retrograde is that the answer requires the full walk backward before it can be seen.

On October 31st, understand that the sky is offering something. Uranus contact in the sixth house of work and health, sextile from Venus, on Samhain, inside the Deipnon window. What you do or do not do with that is entirely between you and Hekate. I am flagging it, not prescribing it.

On November 13th, mark the direct station. Whatever has been unclear may resolve within a few days of that date, one direction or the other.

Between mid November and mid February, Venus is going to make a long series of supportive contacts to almost every load bearing point in your chart. This is the harvest. Whatever you learned during the retrograde becomes usable, and the sky supports what you build with it.

A closing note

Your Venus year is not an easy year in the standard sense. Venus in Scorpio, which is where the year began, is Venus in her detriment. But your solar return and your natal chart together make it clear that this is not a difficult year, it is a year of revision. The Lord of the Year is going to do the revision work herself, in autumn, in Scorpio, walking backward into Libra. What she teaches you during those forty days is the shape of the year. Take her seriously. Let her walk. Do not rush her.

I remain, as ever, your scholar of the sky.

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